

THE HUMAN TARGET

Written by

Lorenzo Besana

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)
When you make a living out of
taking bullets for others, you
don't get to be surprised if the
teller calls your number.

EXT. NEW YORK STREETS - NIGHT

A black suburban drives down the empty streets.

INT. SUBURBAN - SAME TIME

The driver- late 40's, jacket and tie - looks in the
rearview mirror. CAMERA follows his gaze to find his boss
GIANMARCO GROTTI- 50's, bald, wearing a stunning three-piece
suit- staring pensively out the tinted windows.

DRIVER
Everything okay, Mr. Grotti?

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)
You can prepare as much as you
want. We are taught to prepare as
much as we can. But you never know
when it's going to happen. You
can't. There's no formula for it.

GROTTI
Just make sure to park right at the
front, okay?

DRIVER
Yessir.

EXT. NEW YORK STREETS - CONTINUOUS

The suburban speeds up.

CURB - BEHIND SUBURBAN - LOW ANGLE

The suburban tires screech as they get to an alt mere
centimetres away from the curb.

We follow the driver's slightly worn out shoes as he gets
out of his seat and walks around the car to open Mr.
Grotti's door.

IMMACULATE, SHINING, black leather shoes step out of the
vehicle, perfectly perpendicular to the driver's.

The driver's left foot slightly TWISTS on its tiptoes.

Grotti doesn't move.

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)
We are taught to take our time. We
are taught to account for
everything as data. To mold our
behaviour as a function of the
empirical evidence around us.

GROTTI
I'll be right back.

Grotti proceeds ahead.

CAMERA ELEVATES to capture Grotti's back as he walks towards
a seemingly closed restaurant called "CAVALLO PAZZO" (crazy
horse).

CAMERA TRACKS Grotti as he pushes the door open.

INT. CAVALLO PAZZO - CONTINUOUS

Lights are off, but for a single candle lighting up a round
table in the middle of the dining area.

At the table, besides a bottle of whisky and two glasses,
sits GIACOMO CARELLI (60's, grey hair, grey suit). Behind
him a young man in a tight black t-shirt makes no pretence
to hide the 9mm tucked in his trousers.

Carelli pours himself a tall drink.

CARELLI
Please, Gian, have a seat.

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)
Is there light? Or is it dark? Why
is that? What does it smell like?
Did they bleach something? Why is
that? Is it loud? Is it quiet? Are
you alone? Could you tell if you
weren't? Why is that? Are there
weapons? Anything could be a weapon
in the right hands, what could be a
weapon? Why is that? This a million
times a second, every single
second.

Grotti proceeds to take a seat.

CARELLI
Care for a drink?

GROTTI
Always.

Carelli starts pouring and as he is about to stop-

GROTTI
You can keep going.

Carelli holds for a second, considering, then keeps pouring.

GROTTI (CONT'D)
I had a long week.

CARELLI
I'm sure you did.

Carelli puts down the bottle and closes it.

CARELLI
Salud!

GROTTI
Cheers.

They join glasses and as they do, a loud THUMP is heard in the back.

Grotti doesn't flinch. He takes a sip.

CARELLI
Franco is packing up in the back.

GROTTI
I didn't say anything.

Carelli puts down his glass without taking a sip.

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)
They teach to be on alert for any variation of anything, but they can't teach you to pick out what's relevant. What's intentional? What's a reflex? What's a mistake? Assume you are being deceived and you'll lose track of what's earnest. Most people are earnest.

CARELLI
So- let's cut to chase. I promised Junior I would read him a story before bed time.

GROTTI
Isn't it a bit late for that?

CARELLI
It is. It is.

He finally takes a sip.

CARELLI (CONT'D)
So you know what that means right?
I broke a promise. Do you think
Junior will be pleased with that?

GROTTI
I have to say I don't know. Do you
break promises often?

Carelli BOLTS TO HIS FEET and SWOOPS his glass to the side,
smashing it into a wall.

The young man behind moves his hand to the GRIP OF HIS GUN.

CARELLI
ARE YOU FUCKING WITH ME GROTTI?! DO
YOU UNDERSTAND WHAT THE FUCK IS
HAPPENING RIGHT NOW?! ARE YOU
FUCKING DUMB?! EH?!

As Carelli keeps berating Grotti, his voice fades to the
background, replaced by

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)
Human behaviour is difficult to
catalog. Most people are
instinctive, they make decisions,
huge life-changing decisions based
on the turmoil of a single,
fleeting feeling. If you know
someone enough even their emotions
become data, they come predictable.
You can find a pattern in them,
exploit them to your advantage.

Carelli, in a fit of rage, takes the gun out of his
henchman's pants and puts it right in the middle of Grotti's
forehead.

CARELLI
I'LL FUCKING KILL YOU NOW! DO YOU
UNDERSTAND ME YOU FUCKING PIECE OF
SHIT?!!!

As Carelli screams, we see a door being pushed ajar in the
background.

A silhouette appears in the yellow coming out of it.

The silhouette extends a REVOLVER and shoots Carelli in the
middle of his back.

Blood splatters all over Grotti.

The henchman dries to FLEE but a bullet to the back of the head cuts his flight short.

Grotti wipes his hands.

The silhouette walks towards him and hands him an identical change of clothes and a towel.

GROTTI

Thank you very much, you are too kind.

EXT. CAVALLO PAZZO - MINUTES LATER

The driver is smoking a cigarette, leaning on his own car.

He hears sirens sprinting in the background.

The Cavallo Pazzo door swings open, Grotti walks out looking the same as when he walked in.

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)

They teach you to forgo the concept of control itself. You predict, you don't control. You can't change the outcome, you just make sure to be ready for whatever that outcome might be.

GROTTI

Let's get the fuck out of here.

The driver opens the door, Grotti steps in.

The driver runs around the car and SPRINTS AWAY.

CURB - LATER - LOW ANGLE

The tires stop a bit further away from the curb than before.

The driver, once again, steps out of the vehicle and opens Grotti's door.

EXT. GROTTI'S RESIDENCE - CONTINUOUS

Grotti walks towards his door steps.

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)

It doesn't hurt that it's always the same outcome.

Grotti is SHOT in the back and collapses over his own doorsteps.

The driver quickly runs to the body, but as soon he touches him, Grotti turns around with FELINE AGILITY and puts him in a GUILOTTINE CHOKE.

The driver wriggles and punches and screams until the lights go out.

Grotti pushes him over, before picking him up on his shoulder and throwing him in the truck of the suburban.

Unfazed, Grotti heads for the driver seat.

INT. SUBURBAN - CONTINUOUS

Grotti looks at himself in the rearview mirror, then calmly drives ahead.

EXT. DEMOLITION CENTER - LATER

Two men stand in front of a beat-up car- one shorter one taller- the headlights behind them don't allow to see anything but their silhouettes and the BRIEFCASE between their feet.

The suburban drives into the demolition centre right in front of them.

Grotti steps out and starts walking towards them, they follow his lead, the taller man carrying the briefcase.

As they get within reach of each other, we realise one of those two men also LOOKS LIKE GIANMARCO GROTTI.

The new Grotti smiles amused.

NEW GROTTI

I am a fine motherfucker, aren't I,
Jim?

The tall man nods.

NEW GROTTI

I have to say this is fucking eerie
though. Can you take that shit off?

GROTTI

Thought you'd never ask.

NEW GROTTI

Please stop doing the voice.

The Grotti we have been following till now starts PEELING off each layer of his disguise. From the bald cap, to fake nose and ears, to the contacts, the lashes.

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)

To become someone else it's not just about a mask. Anyone can put on a mask. Anyone can do a voice. People don't fall for the mask, they fall for the lie. A good lie is not plausible, it's undeniable.

Finally, underneath the prosthetics, emerges CHRISTOPHER CHANCE- late 30's, dark hair, dark eyes, big scar on right cheek bone.

GROTTI

That's better.

CHRISTOPHER

I'll take that as a compliment.

GROTTI

So- is it done?

CHRISTOPHER

He is in the truck.

GROTTI

Is he dead?

CHRISTOPHER

I wasn't hired to kill.

GROTTI

What about Carelli?

CHRISTOPHER

Dealt with.

GROTTI

"Dealt with". I have to this is the best fucking service.

CHRISTOPHER

(RE: the briefcase)

That's what that is for.

The tall guy hands Christopher the briefcase.

Christopher lightly shakes it.

CHRISTOPHER

Sounds good- if we are done here
I'd like to get one with my
business.

GROTTI

Are you not going to count them?

Christopher smiles slightly.

CHRISTOPHER

Gianmarco, I know where your kids
go to school. Where your wife goes
to pilates. Where your mistress
works. You know better than that. I
know where your mum-

GROTTI

Don't.

Christopher notices the tall guy's shoulder tensing, he
points at him.

CHRISTOPHER

I know everything about you too,
Jimbo. I'm not the only one who
does. I have a lot of friends.
Friends who owe me more than one
favour. Friends who are waiting for
nothing more than a chance to run.
(a beat)

Christopher relaxes his shoulders, smiles coyly.

CHRISTOPHER

Now guys, have a great night, but
make sure to pick up all that
prosthetic shit. I don't like to
litter.

Christopher walks around a frozen Jim and enters what it's
actually his car.

CHRISTOPHER POV

Grotti and Jim look back at him in disbelief. Christopher
WAVES at them and quickly reverses before bolting away.

INT. CHRISTOPHER'S CAR - LATER

Christopher drives fast, out of state. A THICK body suit
with the bullet still pierced in the middle lays above the
briefcase he has just received.

CHRISTOPHER (V.O.)

You see most people hire my services out of fear. They know their time is up, but they don't want to go yet. They want to cling on for just a few more hours. They don't realise what it means to allow someone, someone like me, to be them. I made my peace with my hours. I have as many as I do and not one more. I am okay with that and you are not. So I'll be you. I'll wear your skin as mine and I will die in your place, but make no mistake about it: if I don't die, you are just as much of a *human target*.

OPEN CREDITS: THE HUMAN TARGET

INT. BAR - NIGHT

Cristopher sits alone at the bar, there's no one else around, not even the bartender. He only has an almost empty bottle of whiskey to keep him company.

All the chairs, but his stool, have already been turned and most of the light are already off.

The bartender emerges from the back.

BARTENDER

John, I'm sorry to do this, it's time to go.

Christopher makes an effort to bring up his head and nods.

He pours the last of the bottle in the glass shot and downs it.

Christopher collects his black coat before stumbling down from his stool.

BARTENDER

Be careful out there.

Christopher drunkenly smiles between himself and proceeds to amble to the exit.

CHRISTOPHER

(as he leaves)

Goodnight, chief!

The bartender goes over to Christopher's seat to collect the bottle and glass, where he notices Christopher left behind a \$100 bill.

EXT. STREET - SAME TIME

It's cold. Wind blows harshly into Christopher's warm face. He tightens his coat.

He strides ahead. The wind blows harder. He starts coughing but doesn't stop walking.

He coughs harder and harder. The cough causes him to flinch and contract, until it forces him to the ground.

Christopher manages to get back to his feet between a cough and another. He struggles to reach shelter between two shops doors. He back his head against the wall and slides to the ground.

He sits with his head above knees to his chest, coughing now and then. He stares ahead absentmindedly, then closes his eyes. He tries to fight it, shaking himself awake, but eventually dozes off.

Moments later, an SUV pulls over right in front of him.

Christopher doesn't open his eyes.

A flashlight blasts into his face. He doesn't move.

FEMALE VOICE (O.C.)
Chance! Get the fuck up!

Christopher tries to look ahead but clearly can't see anything.

FEMALE VOICE (O.C.)
Just grab him.

The flashlight goes off.

Two muscular men step to Christopher and forcefully pick him.

They drag him to the car and slam him in the back seat.

The car quickly drives away.

INT. SUV - DAY

Cristopher springs awake and bangs his head against the car window in the backseat. We can see the DESERT behind him. It's the early morning. It's hot.

He pats himself down as he scans around to assess his surroundings. Quickly realising where he is, he sharply stops and composedly lays back against his seat.

Christopher stares ahead for a second, then peeps over to the driver.

CHRISTOPHER

What is this? I'm not dying for another month.

CAMERA tracks Christopher gaze to reveal MARINA CHILTON-40's, dark hair, tight ponytail, sunglasses- the driver, his handler.

MARINA

What happened to good morning, Christopher?

CHRISTOPHER

What happened to not kidnapping people?

MARINA

Next time I'll make sure to leave you to Lorenz Hart out of this miserable life.

Christopher shakes his head, brings his eyes to the emptiness of the desert.

His temples are banging. He loosens his neck and gulps. He squints his eyes.

MARINA

Lorenz Hart died-

CHRISTOPHER

I know how Lorenz Hart died, Marina. Next time do that. Thank you very much.

MARINA

Your wish is my command.

Marina abruptly stops the car.

She turns to Christopher and gestures to the door handle.

CHRISTOPHER

What?

MARINA

Go. Walk out. Die. I don't care.

CHRISTOPHER

Marina.

MARINA

Christopher.

CHRISTOPHER

I'm just a bit-

MARINA

You are hangover as shit, you smell like a wet dog and look like a homeless dude that robbed a finance guy but was too dumb to get anything off of him but his suit.

CHRISTOPHER

Am I not allowed to?

MARINA

As I have already mentioned- I get your memory might not be at his sharpest at the moment, but please pay attention when I speak- Go. Ahead. Die. I. Don't. Care.

CHRISTOPHER

I wouldn't be in this car if that were the case.

MARINA

I see those wheels are starting to spin again.

(beat)

You do realise you *feel* like you were kidnapped because you were passed out between a bakery and a print shop right? Like- I came to get you, to- you know- give you your next assignment. It's what I do. It's what we do. It doesn't really give me any pleasure that I had to think ahead and bring along two gorillas in the not-so-off-chance you would be a drunken mess.

Christopher rubs his hands all over his face.

CHRISTOPHER

I already have my next assignment.

MARINA

It's canceled.

CHRISTOPHER
Since when do we cancel
assignments?

MARINA
Apparently since people are willing
to pay bonkers amounts of money to
secure the services of Mr.
Christopher Chance specifically.
And you know I'm not easily
impressed so when I say bonkers I
truly mean a ridiculous,
disgusting, crypto-capitalist,
mendacious amount of money.

Christopher tilts his head, a little spark shines in his
eyes.

CHRISTOPHER
Is it-?

MARINA
Yeah. It is.

CHRISTOPHER
In how long?

She opens the glove compartment and takes a large folder
out.

She hands it back to Christopher.

She restarts the car.

MARINA
Soon as you are ready.

Christopher looks down at the folder, on the cover it says:

'#260432- Dr. Sasha Ramon Riddle'.

Christopher opens the folder and dives right in.

Marina looks back at him in the rearview mirror, a
complacent smile carving on her cheeks.

EXT. DESERT - SAME TIME

Marina's SUV drives forward over the empty roads.

EXT. DESERT - LATER

Heat hazes over the asphalt, Marina's tyres rupture through
it in their stride.

INT. SUV - CONTINUOUS

Christopher closes the folder and tosses it over the passenger seat.

MARINA

Done?

CHRISTOPHER

It's not complete. Not even close to it.

MARINA

I know.

CHRISTOPHER

This is not how we do things.

MARINA

Debatable. I think, it's close enough.

CHRISTOPHER

Easy to say when you are not the one taking the bullet.

MARINA

So you think it's going to be a bullet.

CHRISTOPHER

Feels like it.

MARINA

I told you it's close enough.

Cristopher shakes his head, looks out the car window. Absolutely nothing in sight. Just sand. An endless sea of sand.

CHRISTOPHER

Do you have something to drink? I feel like I am having nails corked into my skull from the inside.

Marina scoffs.

MARINA

There's going to be a day when you are not going to be able to this anymore.

CHRISTOPHER
That's the whole idea of the
profession, I'm aware.

Marina takes one hand off the wheel and slides open the lid of the compartment between the front seats revealing TWO FLASKS.

Christopher immediately reaches for one, but Marina slaps his hand away and covers the flasks.

CHRISTOPHER
Why would you bring it along if I
can't have it?

MARINA
You can have it. First say that
you'll do it. That you are ready.

Christopher closes his eyes, takes a deep breath.

CHRISTOPHER
I'll do it. I'm ready.

Marina unobstructs the drinks. Christopher dives in and takes them both.

He hides one of them in the inner pocket of his jacket.

As Marina observes him in the rearview mirror, he avidly takes a swing from the flask.

Christopher closes back the flask.

CHRISTOPHER
That's better.

MARINA
No shit.

CHRISTOPHER
Much better.

MARINA
Great.

Marina swerves the wheel to the right, heading straight for the middle of the desert.

Christopher is tossed around the backseats.

CHRISTOPHER
What the fuck are you doing?!

MARINA

This took way too long. We are
late. You got a plane to catch.

EXT. DESERT - CONTINUOUS

Marina's SUV darts forward and increased speed, clouds of
sand surrounding the whole vehicle.

EXT. LANDING STRIP - LATER

The sun is setting in the background of a black charter jet.
Four heavily armed guards stand on the sides of the already
deployed plane stairs.

Marina's SUV comes into the frame and immediately stops in
its tracks as the guards point their MGs at it.

INT. SUV - SAME TIME

Marina turns to Christopher.

MARINA

Stay inside.

CHRISTOPHER

I don't like this.

She smiles.

MARINA

My mum says hi, Chris.

CHRISTOPHER

What does your mum have to do with
anything?

MARINA

She is going to make it.

She tilts her head, smiles more tenderly.

Marina exits the car.

We stay on Christopher.

Marina walks around the car and opens the trunk.

Christopher turns on the seat to face her.

CHRISTOPHER

Marina. What the fuck are you
doing?

Marina lifts a LEATHER BRIEFCASE to show it to Christopher.

MARINA
Equipment.

CHRISTOPHER
Stop it. I have the money. I don't
need-

MARINA
Just please stay in the car,
Christopher, I'm begging you.

Marina shuts the trunk and closes the car.

CHRISTOPHER POV: we see Marina head towards the four guards
holding the briefcase.

She reaches them and hands over the briefcase and car keys.

As he takes a swing from his flask, with a resigned look on
his face, Christopher observes one of the guards handcuffing
Marina and taking her to the hangar behind the plane. One
other guard climbs on the plane holding the briefcase.

The other two guards head to Christopher. He keeps drinking.

The guards reach Christopher and open his door.

GUARD #1
Please step out of the vehicle, Mr.
Chance.

Christopher doesn't turn to face them.

CHRISTOPHER
I will. In a minute.

He takes one more sip from the flask and steps out of the
car without looking at the guards.

LANDING STRIP

One of them pats him down, finding the other flask in the
inner pocket. The guard opens it and smells it. He retches
before putting it back.

GUARD #2

This way, Mr. Chance.

Christopher starts heading towards the stairs, the guards
behind him.

They reach the hangar. Cristopher peeps inside, but he doesn't see Marina nor the other guard. Only heavy building machinery.

Christopher stops.

CHRISTOPHER
She's dead isn't she?

GUARD #2
We don't know what you are talking
about Mr. Chance.

Christopher keeps walking and starts climbing onto the plane. One guard follows him, the other stays behind.

As Christopher and the guard reach the cabin, the stairs are quickly retracted.

Jet engines start to roar. The guard has barely the time to move away before the jet quickly powers towards take off.

The plane takes off.

The guard signals into the hangar.

Bulldozer and excavators emerge from it. Within in moments graders are erasing the reaming straight tracks in the sand.

The hanger itself it's quickly deflated. The pieces stored in pick-up trucks.

The guard jumps into one of the bulldozers.

They all take off in different directions, leaving nothing behind but the desert.

INT. JET - MOMENTS LATER

As the plane stabilises in the sky, Christopher and the guard stand in a little compartment before the cabin.

CHRISTOPHER
What are we waiting for?

The guard points at the red light above the door to the cabin.

CHRISTOPHER
Jesus.

He tries to take one more sip, but the flask is empty.

He hands it to the guard.

GUARD #2
I'm not your butler.

CHRISTOPHER
Not yet.

The light above the door turns green.

GUARD #2
You may go.

Christopher drops the flask to the ground and walks into the cabin.

CABIN

It's artificially bright. All the window blinds are down. Christopher squints.

RIDDLE (O.C.)
Mr. Chance!

CAMERA finds SASHA RAMON RIDDLE- late 40's, tan, white suit, dark hair- sitting opposite to Christopher, his leg crossed as he rests his arm over the adjacent seat. In front him there are a bottle of whiskey, two inlaid glasses and a folder with Christopher's name on it.

RIDDLE (CONT'D)
Please! Have a seat.

Christopher proceeds ahead and takes an extremely composed sit on Riddle's diagonal.

RIDDLE
Care for a drink?

Christopher takes out his own flask and rests it on the table.

RIDDLE
You came prepared.

CHRISTOPHER
Isn't that the point?

RIDDLE
You are a funny one, aren't you?

CHRISTOPHER
I can be many things.

RIDDLE
Isn't that the point?

Riddle pours himself a drink and raises his glass.

RIDDLE

To Marina.

Christopher doesn't reply, just raises his glass.

RIDDLE

It's noble- y'know- what she did.

Riddle holds for a moment, but Christopher doesn't flinch, doesn't move a muscle.

Riddle smiles, pleased, then downs his drink. Christopher takes a sip.

Riddle puts down his glass and scoots over to sit right in front of Christopher. He frantically starts tapping his palms on the table.

RIDDLE

We finally meet, Mr. Chance.

Cristopher nods.

RIDDLE

I assume you must be wondering why
I specifically asked for you. Why I
was willing to pay so much for you.

CHRISTOPHER

I'm not.

Riddle smirks.

RIDDLE

You have read the file, right?

CHRISTOPHER

Can we stop this little dance and
go the point, Sasha?

RIDDLE

No one calls me like that.

CHRISTOPHER

Not even Kaja?

RIDDLE

Don't talk about my wife.

CHRISTOPHER

Is mentioning her name enough to
rile you up like this?

Cristopher points at Riddle shaking hands.

RIDDLE

I'M NOT-

(clears his throat,
smiles)

I'm not riled up. I would just
prefer if we kept our families out
of this.

CHRISTOPHER

Is that a threat, Sasha?

Riddle closes his eyes, summoning every ounce of constraint
he can find.

CHRISTOPHER

Is it the drinking, or are you
always this person? Are you this
person with Kaja?

RIDDLE

I know what you are doing.

CHRISTOPHER

Good. You should. Because whoever
has decided to kill you
realistically operates within your
inner circle. And you know what
people in your inner circle are
aware of? People like me. Human
targets. I was suggested to you by
someone. You would have never known
I existed otherwise.

RIDDLE

Are you saying whoever-

CHRISTOPHER

I don't know. Not yet. But I have
to think about these things. It's
my job, but I can only do it if you
allow me to be you. You are not
allowed dishonesty when you speak
to me. All it takes is a
discrepancy. A change of attitude.
A man that turns apoplectic at the
mention of his wife to not throw a
fit when a drink is spilled on him.
Then they'll know and then it's
just a matter of waiting a week
before putting a bullet in your
skull.

Cristopher takes a big swing from his flask.

RIDDLE

That's a good theory, Christopher.
And I could get behind it, you
know, the idea that they are trying
to spook me enough for me to play
my trump card too early and be
ultimately fucked. But it doesn't
make sense.

CHRISTOPHER

Because Kaja mentioned me.

Riddle nods, downs his drink.

RIDDLE

This is not the first time you meet
me, is it?

CHRISTOPHER

I'm afraid no, Sasha.

RIDDLE

When?

CHRISTOPHER

Can't tell you that.

Riddle pours himself another drink. Stares right at
Christopher and scoffs.

RIDDLE

Just don't fuck my wife.

Chris shakes his head, amused. He takes a sip then rests his
back on his seat.

Christopher closes his eyes.

CHRISTOPHER

Do you fuck your wife?

SKY

Sasha's jet cruises through the clouds.

EXT. GRAND HOTEL - DAY

SUPER: BORAVIA - EMERGENCY WAR SUMMIT

Brisk snow covers the garden surrounding Luchebic's grand
hotel.

Reporters gather around heavily armed military forming a cordon around the entrance.

Right in the front line, we find LOIS LANE reporting live.

LOIS LANE
Tension grows in Moravia as,
following last week attempted
bombing of the former-parliament
building by the FFB, president
Ghurkos has invited multi-
billionaire arms-dealer Sasha Ramon
Riddle-

CAMERA OPERATOR (O.C.)
You can't say that.

LOIS LANE
I'm sorry?

CAMERA OPERATOR (O.C.)
Arms-dealer.

LOIS LANE
He is an arms-dealer.

CAMERA OPERATOR (O.C.)
He is a philanthropist and tech
mogul.

LOIS LANE
Oh shut the f-

CAMERA OPERATOR (O.C.)
Shit! There he is!

Behind Lois, an heavily armoured car slowly starts pulling up towards the entrance.

As the car approaches we see Guard #2 from earlier sitting in the passenger sit. A hand from the back taps his shoulder, he turns to the driver and murmurs something.

The car proceeds and stops with the back seat window next to Lois. The window slowly rolls down revealing a smiling Sasha sitting alone in the backseats.

Journalists and photographer try to crowd the window screaming for Sasha, but military holds them off.

SASHA
Lois Lane, right?

LOIS LANE
That would be, yes.

SASHA
I read your article about Enigmatic
exploitation of the natural
resources in Nicaragua. Poignant
writing. Thought-provoking.

LOIS LANE
Are you denying the content of the
article?

Sasha widens his eyes, then squints them noticing Lois was
completely serious.

SASHA
I'm many things but I'm not a liar
miss Lane.

LOIS LANE
You are a bad person.

SASHA
Someone has to.

Sasha taps the guard shoulder. The windows rolls up and car
proceeds towards the entrance.

LOIS LANE
(to Camera Operator)
Did you get that?

CAMERA OPERATOR (O.C.)
What do you think?

INT. PRESIDENTIAL ROOM - MOMENTS LATER

President Ghurkos (60's, fat, balding) stands in front of
the window, peeking at flood of reports from behind the
curtain. His aids, Maria (20's, dark hair) and Kostas (40's,
bald), sit on the on couch in the middle of the suite. Maria
is on her laptop, Kostas is going through stacks of paper.

GHURKOS
(in Boverian)
Fucking 'roaches. That's what they
are. Thirty years I have been
leading this nation. Thirty years
of prosperity I have given this
country. No one said fucking thank
you.

(MORE)

GHURKOS (CONT'D)

Then a no good junkie terrorist
dies and they all swarm the places
like goddamn flies on a piece of
shit.

He slams his open palm against the window.

KOSTAS

(in Bavarian)

You should keep calm.

MARIA

(in English)

That vein on your neck is going to
pop anytime now.

KOSTAS

Maria.

MARIA

What? It's huge. It's gotta have a
life of its own by now.

Ghurkos turn to them, seething.

GHURKOS

(in Bavarian)

Where the hell is Riddle?

KOSTAS

(in Bavarian)

He is in the building.

GHURKOS

(In Bavarian)

Oh is he? And is he going to
dignify with his presence or is he
already drinking himself numb in
his goddamn room?

MARIA

(pointing at Ghurkos
neck, in English)

There it is.

GHURKOS

Shut up Maria.

A knock is heard on the door.

KOSTAS

(in Bavarian)

Who is it?

SOLDIER (O.S.)
 (in Bovarian)
 Your guest is here.

SASHA (O.S.)
 I would prefer "your saviour is
 here" but sure. Let's go with
 guest.

KOSTAS
 Let him in.

The doors swing open. Sasha comes in galavanting followed by
 his loyal guard. Maria and Kostats instantly stand up.
 Ghurkos steps towards the centre of the room.

Sasha opens his arms.

SASHA
 Vasil!

GHURKOS
 You are late.

SASHA
 Is that how you greet an old
 friend?

Sasha step to Ghurkos they awkwardly hug and share one kiss
 per each cheek.

SASHA
 That's better, right?

GHURKOS
 I am very stressed Mr. Riddle.

SASHA
 I understand that, Vasil.

GHURKOS
 This rebels, this terrorists, they
 are the scum of the earth. They
 want to take Boravia way from me.
 The country my father build, the
 country my father died taking back
 from the germans. They want to
 destroy it by importing the
 degradation of the western world.

SASHA
 And you know I hate the
 degeneration of the West as much as
 the next fellow.

Sasha turns to Maria and Kostas. Point at Kostas.

SASHA
Kostas, right?

KOSTAS
Yes, sir.

Sasha points at Maria.

SASHA
And who's the bimbo?

MARIA
I beg your pardon?

SASHA
It was meant as a compliment.

MARIA
Jesus Christ.

SASHA
My bad. Okay let's not get all
railed up over some cultural
differences.

MARIA
I'm from Chicago.

SASHA
I swear I couldn't care less.

MARIA
(to Ghurkos, in Boravian)
This was a mistake.

SASHA
(to Ghurkos, in Boravian)
I went her gone.

Ghurkos looks at Maria, then at Sasha, then with his head
gestures to Maria to leave.

MARIA
Un-fucking-believable.

SASHA
Sayonara sweetheart.

MARIA
Fuck you.

Maria picks up the lap top and leaves.

The guard puts a drink in Sasha's hand. He takes a deep sip.

SASHA
Feisty one you got there, eh?

KOSTAS
Mr. Riddle, if you are done with
this little shared, I'd like to
move on to the issue at hand.

SASHA
You know what? I like you Kostas,
let's do that.

Ghurkos moves back to the window, Kostas collects a bunch of
paper and hands them to Sasha.

KOSTAS
As you can see, Mr. Riddle, the
rebels-

GHURKOS
Terrorists.

KOSTAS
Right. The terrorists have taken a
stronghold over the western region
of the country. They have annexed
multiple villages within the Alps'
valleys and are cutting out the
cities supplies. At that, sources
tell us they are preparing an
offensive towards the capital.

SASHA
You have no way of attacking by
land.

GHURKOS
That is correct.

SASHA
And you don't have the technology
to hit specific targets without
completely fucking your food
resources.

GHURKOS
And killing hundreds of my people.

SASHA
And that. Of course.

Sasha downs his drink.

SASHA

Well, fellas, I think the solution is pretty easy.

GHURKOS

You talk about war and you say pretty easy.

SASHA

Yeah. Of course. You give me locations, a lot of money *and* a bunch of land over there to do whatever the fuck I want with and all your problems will magically disappear before the morning news.

Ghurkos turns to Kostas, nods.

Kostas extends his hand, Sasha energetically shakes on it.

SASHA

Pleasure doing business with the great nation of Boravia.

